Strategies to manage the usage of mobile in a digital well-being context: Android case study

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Summary: **This dissertation proposes the development of an Android-based solution to monitor and manage smartphone usage, promoting digital well-being through privacy-preserving, user-centred interventions.**

Objectives / Work done / Results

Analysis of Articles Related to:

- Digital well-being interventions and their effectiveness
- Android mechanisms to monitor and restrict smartphone use
- Alternatives to smartphone use, such as digital detox and dumbphones

Existing solutions:

- **Monitoring:** Tracks screen time and app usage
- **Friction:** Introduces delays and interaction barriers
- **Blocking:** Restricts access through app limits and lockouts
- **Minimal devices:** Simplifies interfaces and reduces device functionality

Key Findings:

- Digital Wellbeing is mostly passive reports
- Friction is more accepted than blocking
- Users want selective control
- Time saved in one app often moves to other apps
- Fixed interventions lose effect over time

Next Steps / Challenges / Bottlenecks

Analysis of Articles Related to:

- Smartwatches as a lower-distraction companion to the phone

Choose intervention approaches

Define the prototype architecture

Define the evaluation method

Challenges:

- Accessibility-based designs face Play Store restrictions
- Permission onboarding may put users off